When Walter Hall tested the ToolPost's Compac tools, he observed:

'... when these new Compac tools arrived for testing, I was not expecting to be impressed. I was wrong.'

He continued:

'These are not the usual miniature tools but seriously reduced length versions of full-size tools. They are specifically designed to make turning easier on smaller lathes where the reduced swing and length between centres can make access with long-handled tools difficult. They allow the turner to more easily attain the correct positioning of the cutting edge and handle movement when working within the constraints of a small machine, thus making it easier to exercise good practice and better tool control.'

And concluded:

'These are well-designed and robust tools made from exellent quality materials. They will make an excellent partnership with any of the smaller lathes and fill an imporant niche gap in the market'

In fact, all of these things were said by Walter Hall when he reviewed the Compactool set for 'Woodturning' in Issue 276 (Feb. 2015).

We find ourselves agreeing wholeheartedly with Walter, but then we did design these tools and they are unique to The ToolPost. So, naturally, we're proud of them - and of the great success they have been, helping many turners become better turners. But it's certainly nice to have truly independent corroboration of our views from such a well-respected, experienced and knowledgeable turner as Walter Hall. We take our hats off to this very insightful gentleman.

A typical small lathe has just 6 inches of space between spindle axis and bed. A typical bowl gouge is 23 inches long. You can't fit that into a six-inch space and present it to the workpiece correctly. The new CompacTool bowl gouge measures just 10½ inches overall so it isn't hard to understand why that fits so much better into the available space is it?

Between headstock and tailstock you've maybe got 20 inches at most – and 4 inches less when your workpiece is mounted in a chuck. A standard bowl scraper is 17 inches long. The new CompacTool bowl finishing scraper has the same cross-section as a standard heavy scraper but is only 10 inches long. That fits. Comfortably.

So you see, now at last someone is thinking about your needs when you work on your mini lathe. That's why the new CompacTool set is unique to The ToolPost: we're the folk who think about your needs first. CompacTool: designed for you. By us. Manufactured exclusively for The ToolPost by Hamlet Craft Tools in Sheffield, UK.

Invest £120.00* in a set of new CompacTools, today, or buy them individually and you'll have six of the best reasons ever for owning a compact lathe. And six new ways of creating great work. Available from their creators, The ToolPost, right now.

The ToolPost

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